

Faculty and Administration AI Use Guide - Draft

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Audience: Faculty, instructional staff, academic leadership, administration, and staff using AI in college work

Related student-facing document: [Standard_Student_AI_Use_Policy.md](#)

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Purpose

This guide translates the college's AI Acceptable Use Policy into practical, human-facing expectations for faculty and administration.

The formal policy defines institutional requirements. This guide explains how people should behave when using AI in daily academic, administrative, and operational work.

It is intended to help faculty and staff use AI responsibly, protect students and institutional data, preserve human judgment, and create clear course-level expectations.

Core Principle

AI may assist college work.

AI may not replace human responsibility, professional judgment, academic authority, or institutional accountability.

If faculty or staff use AI, they remain responsible for:

- knowing whether the tool is approved for the intended use
- protecting student, employee, and college data
- reviewing and validating AI-generated output
- correcting inaccurate, biased, incomplete, or inaccessible content
- disclosing AI use when appropriate
- making final decisions themselves
- ensuring students are not disadvantaged by unclear or inconsistent AI expectations

AI should support human agency. It should not obscure who made a decision, who is accountable for a communication, or who holds authority in a course, department, or institutional process.

Relationship to Student AI Use

This guide should be read alongside the college's student AI use standard.

The student-facing standard establishes that students may use AI only within course and assignment boundaries, and that students remain responsible for understanding, testing, revising, explaining, and disclosing their work.

Faculty and administration should apply the same principle to themselves:

AI assistance does not remove human responsibility for the final result.

Some redundancy between this guide and student-facing AI guidance is intentional. Faculty need enough overlap to write clear course rules, explain expectations to students, and model the responsible use they require from learners.

Important Terms

Artificial Intelligence or AI

AI refers to software systems that can generate, summarize, classify, predict, recommend, analyze, or transform information in ways that resemble human reasoning, communication, or decision support.

Examples may include chatbots, writing assistants, image generators, transcription tools, coding assistants, automated grading tools, predictive analytics systems, embedded copilot tools, and AI features built into enterprise software.

Generative AI

Generative AI refers to AI tools that create new content, such as text, code, images, audio, video, summaries, lesson materials, rubrics, emails, feedback, quizzes, or reports.

Approved AI Tool

An approved AI tool is a tool that has been reviewed and authorized by the college for specific uses.

Approval should be understood as conditional. A tool may be approved for one purpose but not for another. A tool may be approved for public or internal information but not for confidential or restricted data.

When in doubt, faculty and staff should check the approved AI tool inventory or request review before using the tool with college data.

Public Data

Public data is information that is already intended for public release and would not create harm if shared outside the college.

Examples may include published catalog descriptions, public web pages, public event information, general program descriptions, and already-approved marketing language.

Internal Data

Internal data is college information intended for ordinary internal use but not necessarily public release.

Examples may include draft meeting notes, internal planning documents, non-sensitive process drafts, or department-level working materials.

Internal data should be used only in approved AI tools and only when the use aligns with college policy.

Confidential Data

Confidential data is information that could create privacy, legal, operational, academic, financial, or reputational harm if disclosed improperly.

Examples may include non-public student information, employee records, personnel matters, donor information, advising notes, non-public financial information, contract details, internal investigations, or sensitive institutional planning.

Confidential data should not be entered into AI tools unless the tool and use case have been explicitly approved for that data type.

Restricted Data

Restricted data is highly sensitive information that requires the strongest protection.

Examples may include authentication credentials, passwords, API keys, security configurations, protected health information, payment card data, Social Security numbers, certain legal or disciplinary records, and other information subject to strict regulatory, contractual, or security controls.

Restricted data should not be entered into AI tools unless there is explicit written approval through the college's authorized process.

Personally Identifiable Information

Personally identifiable information, often called PII, is information that can identify or reasonably be linked to a specific person.

Examples may include names, student ID numbers, employee ID numbers, email addresses, phone numbers, home addresses, dates of birth, Social Security numbers, demographic details, photographs, account names, IP addresses, or combinations of details that make a person identifiable.

Some people may use the phrase PPI informally, but the common policy term is PII: personally identifiable information.

FERPA-Protected Student Information

FERPA-protected student information includes education records and personally identifiable information from education records.

Examples may include grades, assignment submissions, advising records, attendance details, disability accommodations, conduct records, academic standing, financial aid information, and communications about a specific student's performance or circumstances.

Faculty and staff should assume student-specific academic information is protected unless they have confirmed otherwise.

De-Identified, Masked, or Anonymized Data

De-identified, masked, or anonymized data has had identifying details removed or altered so the information cannot reasonably be connected back to a specific person.

Faculty and staff should be cautious: removing a name is not always enough. A combination of program, course, date, incident, demographic details, and context may still identify a person.

Synthetic Data

Synthetic data is invented or artificially created data used for examples, testing, demonstrations, or training activities.

Synthetic data is often safer for AI use than real student, employee, or institutional data, provided it does not copy or closely resemble actual individuals or confidential situations.

General AI Use Expectations

Faculty and staff may use approved AI tools for appropriate college-related purposes when the use complies with institutional policy, data protection rules, accessibility standards, professional expectations, and applicable law.

AI may be appropriate for:

- brainstorming ideas
- drafting non-sensitive communications
- summarizing public or approved internal materials
- improving grammar, tone, organization, or clarity
- creating first drafts of lesson materials
- generating examples using synthetic data
- outlining meeting agendas
- developing rubrics or assessment language for human review
- exploring alternate explanations of a concept
- reviewing code for possible issues when no restricted data or credentials are included
- improving accessibility of documents, provided the result is verified

AI should not be used to:

- make final decisions that materially affect students, employees, applicants, or vendors

- evaluate students without meaningful instructor review
- generate official communications that are sent without human review
- process confidential or restricted data in unapproved tools
- bypass required college procedures
- hide the source of work, analysis, or decisions
- produce content that violates law, policy, professional ethics, copyright, accessibility, or equal opportunity principles

Data Use Rules of Thumb

Before using AI, ask:

- Is this tool approved for this purpose?
- What type of data am I about to provide?
- Could this information identify a student, employee, donor, applicant, patient, vendor, or other person?
- Would it be a problem if this prompt or output became part of a log, public record, vendor system, or legal discovery process?
- Am I using the minimum information necessary?
- Can I use synthetic, masked, or public information instead?

If the answer is unclear, do not enter the information into the AI tool until the use has been reviewed.

Safe Prompting Practices

Faculty and staff should use AI prompts that protect people and institutional data.

Safer prompt:

Create a general explanation of academic probation for a technical college student audience. Do not reference any specific student.

Risky prompt:

Rewrite this advising email to Jordan Smith, student ID 1234567, explaining that they failed two classes and may lose financial aid.

Safer prompt:

Generate three fictional examples of student programming errors involving loops. Use synthetic names and no real student submissions.

Risky prompt:

Analyze these five real student submissions and tell me which students probably used AI.

Safer prompt:

Suggest clearer wording for this public course description.

Risky prompt:

Summarize these confidential personnel notes and recommend what action HR should take.

Human Review and Validation

AI output should be treated as a draft, suggestion, or decision-support artifact, not as final authority.

Faculty and staff should review AI output for:

- factual accuracy
- missing context
- bias or unfair assumptions

- invented citations or unsupported claims
- accessibility
- tone and professionalism
- alignment with college policy
- alignment with course outcomes or department standards
- privacy and confidentiality
- copyright or licensing concerns
- technical security, when code or system configuration is involved

Higher-risk uses require stronger validation. A casual brainstorming output may need light review. A student-facing policy explanation, advising communication, assessment item, legal/compliance summary, or code change may require deeper review, documentation, testing, or consultation.

AI and Academic Authority

Faculty retain academic authority over course design, instruction, feedback, grading, and assessment.

AI may support these activities, but it should not replace the instructor’s professional judgment.

Faculty should not use AI as the sole basis for:

- grades
- academic integrity findings
- accommodations decisions
- admissions decisions
- advising decisions
- disciplinary referrals
- recommendations that materially affect a student

AI-generated feedback should be reviewed before being shared with students. Feedback should reflect the assignment, rubric, course context, and student learning goals.

Course-Level AI Guidance

Each course should clearly state how AI may or may not be used.

Faculty should define:

- whether AI is allowed in the course
- whether AI is allowed only on some assignments
- whether some activities are manual-first or AI-free
- whether students must disclose AI use
- what disclosure should include
- whether students may use AI for brainstorming, drafting, debugging, editing, or final production
- whether AI-generated sources, citations, code, images, or media are allowed
- what students must be able to explain
- what consequences apply when AI use violates course or assignment rules

Course rules should be specific enough that students can comply without guessing.

Template for Course AI Rules

Faculty may adapt the following language:

AI tools may be used in this course only when permitted by the assignment instructions. When AI use is permitted, you remain responsible for understanding, verifying, revising, and explaining your final work.

You may use AI for:

- [allowed use]
- [allowed use]
- [allowed use]

You may not use AI for:

- [restricted use]
- [restricted use]
- [restricted use]

Disclosure requirement:

- [No disclosure required / brief disclosure required / detailed AI use statement required]

Manual-first expectation:

- [Students must attempt the work independently before using AI / Some activities are AI-free / AI may be used throughout the process]

Final accountability:

If you cannot explain, defend, or revise the work you submit, you have not yet met the expectations of the assignment, even if AI helped produce the output.

Sample Course AI Use Levels

Faculty may find it useful to identify a course or assignment as one of the following:

Level 0 - No AI Use

AI use is not allowed for this activity.

This may be appropriate for quizzes, exams, skill checks, foundational practice, or assignments designed to measure unaided performance.

Level 1 - Manual First, AI After Attempt

Students must first attempt the work independently. AI may then be used for clarification, debugging, revision, or reflection.

This may be appropriate when the learning goal is initial skill development.

Level 2 - AI as Support

Students may use AI for brainstorming, planning, explanation, editing, feedback, or improvement, but the student must make final decisions and understand the result.

This may be appropriate for many writing, coding, design, research-preparation, or project-based assignments.

Level 3 - AI as Integrated Tool

Students are expected or encouraged to use AI as part of the workflow, while documenting how they used it and how they evaluated the results.

This may be appropriate for advanced courses, workplace simulation, AI literacy outcomes, or assignments where responsible AI use is itself part of the learning goal.

Disclosure Guidance

Disclosure requirements should match the risk and purpose of the assignment.

Simple disclosure may be enough when AI is used for light brainstorming, grammar, or formatting.

Example:

I used Microsoft Copilot to suggest wording improvements. I reviewed and revised the final text myself.

Detailed disclosure may be appropriate when AI significantly shaped the work.

Example:

I used AI to generate an initial outline, compare two possible approaches, and identify possible errors in my draft. I rejected one suggested section because it did not match the assignment requirements. I verified the final claims using the assigned course materials.

Faculty should avoid disclosure rules that are so broad or vague that students cannot tell what must be reported.

Administrative Use

Administrative staff may use approved AI tools to support appropriate college work, provided they protect data and retain human accountability.

Appropriate uses may include:

- drafting non-sensitive messages
- summarizing public documents
- improving clarity of internal process drafts
- creating meeting agendas
- generating training outlines
- developing checklists
- preparing synthetic examples
- analyzing non-confidential survey themes when approved

Administrative staff should be especially careful with:

- employee records
- student records
- applicant information
- donor information
- financial records
- contract terms
- legal matters
- investigations
- complaints
- accessibility accommodations
- health information
- disciplinary issues

AI should not be used as the sole decision-maker in employment, discipline, financial aid, admissions, accommodations, academic standing, investigations, or other high-impact decisions.

AI-Generated Code and Technical Work

AI may be useful for generating, reviewing, explaining, or refactoring code, but AI-generated technical work must be reviewed before use.

AI-generated code may contain insecure patterns, unsafe dependencies, exposed secrets, flawed logic, licensing issues, or other defects that could make systems vulnerable.

Faculty and staff should not enter passwords, API keys, tokens, credentials, restricted configurations, student records, or confidential system details into AI tools unless the tool and use case have been explicitly approved.

Code or technical recommendations generated by AI should be tested, reviewed, and validated before being used in college systems or student-facing materials.

Accessibility

AI-generated materials must be reviewed for accessibility before use.

Faculty and staff remain responsible for ensuring that AI-assisted documents, slides, images, videos, transcripts, web content, course materials, forms, and communications are accessible.

AI may help identify accessibility issues, but it should not be treated as the final accessibility authority.

Copyright, Attribution, and Intellectual Property

Faculty and staff should be cautious when using AI with copyrighted, licensed, unpublished, or proprietary materials.

Do not upload copyrighted course materials, publisher content, student work, internal documents, or third-party materials into AI tools unless the use is permitted by license, policy, and tool approval.

AI-generated content should be reviewed for originality, citation accuracy, licensing concerns, and appropriate attribution before being published, distributed, or used in official college work.

Incident Response

If confidential, restricted, or protected information is accidentally entered into an unapproved AI tool, faculty and staff should report the incident promptly through the college's designated process.

Do not try to hide or quietly fix the issue alone.

Fast reporting allows the college to assess risk, preserve records, meet legal obligations, and reduce possible harm.

Practical Checklist

Before using AI, ask:

- Is this an approved tool for this use?
- Am I using public, internal, confidential, or restricted data?
- Could this identify a person?
- Is this a high-impact decision?
- Can I accomplish the same goal with less sensitive information?
- Will I review and validate the output?
- Do I need to disclose AI assistance?
- Am I preserving human authority and accountability?

Before sharing or acting on AI output, ask:

- Is it accurate?
- Is it fair?
- Is it accessible?
- Is it appropriate for the audience?
- Does it comply with policy?
- Does it protect privacy?
- Can I explain and defend the final decision or content?

Final Standard

The central question is not simply:

- “Was AI used?”

The stronger question is:

- “Was AI used in a way that protects people, preserves human judgment, respects institutional policy, and produces work the responsible human can explain, verify, and stand behind?”

If the answer is yes, AI has been used responsibly within this guide.